Stablecoin Infrastructure: Institutional Intelligence Report 2025–2026

Synthesizing findings from McKinsey, BCG, Citi, BlackRock, Deloitte, J.P. Morgan, Goldman Sachs, IMF, BIS, Federal Reserve, EY, PwC, WEF, a16z, Fireblocks, and Visa

Executive Summary

Stablecoins have crossed an inflection point. Once confined to crypto-native trading, they are now described by the world's most sophisticated financial institutions as **core financial infrastructure** for payments, settlement, and liquidity management. The total stablecoin market capitalization reached approximately $317 billion by early 2026, up from $120 billion just 18 months earlier. Transaction volume surpassed $46 trillion in 2025 on a gross basis, or an adjusted $9 trillion in organic economic activity. The passage of the U.S. GENIUS Act in July 2025 — the first comprehensive federal stablecoin legislation — alongside Europe's MiCA and frameworks across Singapore, Japan, Hong Kong, and the UAE have collectively removed the largest remaining institutional adoption barrier: regulatory uncertainty.[1][2] [3][4] [^5]

The convergence of regulatory clarity, maturing blockchain infrastructure, and real-world use case validation means 2025 was not just a headline year — it was what Citi GPS called **"blockchain's ChatGPT moment"** for institutional adoption.[6][7]

1. Market Scale and Projections

Current Market Snapshot

By early 2026, the stablecoin market reflects unprecedented growth across every metric:

- **Market Capitalization:** ~$317 billion (Federal Reserve, April 2026), with USDT (~60% share) and USDC (~24%) remaining dominant[5][8]
- **Transaction Volume:** $46 trillion gross in 2025 (a16z), or $9 trillion on an adjusted, organic basis — approaching the scale of the entire ACH banking network in the U.S.[4][9]
- **Daily flows:** ~$30 billion in real on-chain payment transactions daily — still less than 1% of global money flows[^1]
- **Real-economy payments:** $350–$550 billion annually in observable bilateral transactions for goods and services (BCG/Allium, Jan 2026)[^10]

Institutional Market Forecasts (2028–2030)

Institution	Base Case (2030)	Bull Case (2030)	Source
Citi GPS	$1.9 trillion	$4.0 trillion	Stablecoins 2030, Sep 2025[^7]
Goldman Sachs	$1.9 trillion	Higher	Top of Mind, Aug 2025[^11]
J.P. Morgan	$500–750 billion	~$2 trillion	Global Research, Sep 2025[^12]
McKinsey	>$2 trillion by 2028	—	Stable Door Opens, 2025[^1]
U.S. Treasury	~$3 trillion by 2030	—	Sec. Bessent[^13]
BCG + Ripple	Tokenized assets $18.9T by 2033 (CAGR 53%)	$23.4T	Tokenization Tipping Point, Apr 2025[^14]

Citi also projects that at 50x velocity, stablecoins could support **$100 trillion in annual transaction activity** by 2030 under the base case. Stablecoin issuers could hold **over $1 trillion in U.S. Treasuries by 2030**, potentially surpassing the holdings of Japan or China.[7][15]

2. The Infrastructure Stack: How Stablecoins Actually Move

The stablecoin infrastructure is a **five-layer architecture** that each institution building in this space must understand:[^16]

Layer 1: Issuers

The entities that mint and redeem stablecoins against reserves. The dominant issuers are **Tether (USDT)** and **Circle (USDC)**, which collectively hold 88% of total supply. In 2025, banks entered issuance at scale: 10 institutions launched production-grade stablecoins. HSBC and Standard Chartered-backed Anchorpoint received Hong Kong's first stablecoin issuer licenses in April 2026 under the Stablecoins Ordinance. JPMorgan's JPM Coin processes over $1 billion daily in institutional settlement.[17][18] [19][1]

Layer 2: Settlement Rails (Blockchains)

Blockchains function as the underlying settlement layer and have settled into distinct functional roles:[^17]

Blockchain	Role	Characteristics
TRON	High-volume remittances	~60–80% of real-economy payments; ultra-low fees; deep USDT liquidity[^10]
Ethereum	Institutional settlement anchor	$166B in stablecoins hosted; ~65% of tokenized RWA market[^20]
Solana	Fast consumer payments	1–2 second finality, <$0.01 fees[^1]

Blockchain	Role	Characteristics
BNB Smart Chain	Emerging market flows	$35–50B in real-economy stablecoin flows (2025)[^10]
Polygon	Enterprise payments	Fast, low-cost; added to Visa's settlement pilot Apr 2026[^21]

Layer 2 scaling solutions — Arbitrum and Optimism on Ethereum — have further reduced congestion and fees. A new category of "**stablechains**" (purpose-built Layer 1 blockchains designed specifically for stablecoin payments) emerged in 2025, with Visa also expanding its stablecoin settlement pilot to support nine blockchains by April 2026.[21][8] [^1]

Layer 3: Orchestrators and On/Off-Ramps

Orchestrators abstract multi-rail complexity: they route stablecoin transactions across blockchains, manage liquidity, and interface with fiat banking. Cross-chain interoperability protocols include Circle's CCTP (native burn-and-mint for USDC), LayerZero, Wormhole, and Stargate. On-ramps and off-ramps are the critical interface between stablecoin rails and the traditional banking world — and remain the highest source of adoption friction.[22][16]

Layer 4: Custodians

Custodians hold the private keys that authorize stablecoin movement on behalf of institutions and represent the most regulated infrastructure layer. The 2026 roster includes:

- **Fireblocks** — MPC-based key management; secures 15% of global stablecoin volume; powers 35M+ transactions monthly[^23]
- **Anchorage Digital** — first federally chartered digital asset bank in the U.S.[^16]
- **BitGo, Coinbase Custody, Cobo** — institutional-grade custody across jurisdictions[^16]

Fireblocks' 2026 State of Stablecoins report found that **86% of firms report their infrastructure is ready for stablecoin adoption**, with focus now shifted from pilots to execution.[^24]

Layer 5: Compliance, Identity, and Analytics

On-chain analytics have advanced from basic tracking to sophisticated behavioral and risk analysis. Companies including Chainalysis, Elliptic, and TRM Labs provide real-time AML screening, wallet attribution, and sanctions surveillance. This layer is non-negotiable under the GENIUS Act (monthly reserve disclosures, annual audits) and MiCA (full authorization by mid-2026).[8][25] [^1]

3. Key Use Cases and Real-Economy Adoption

Cross-Border Payments (B2B — Largest Use Case)

B2B payments represent ~40% of all real-economy stablecoin transactions and are growing at 65% annually (BCG, 2026). Traditional cross-border infrastructure via SWIFT settles in 3–5 business days at 2–7% in fees; stablecoin rails settle in under 3 minutes, 24/7, at 0.1–0.5% all-in. 56% of financial institutions believe 5–10% of global cross-border payment value will use stablecoins by 2030, equivalent to $2.1 trillion. The U.S. Federal Reserve published a technical paper in March 2026 modeling exactly how stablecoin cross-border settlement mechanics work between small banks in different jurisdictions.[26][27] [^10]

Remittances (C2C — Second Largest)

C2C payments account for ~25% of real-economy stablecoin flows, primarily remittances to Latin America, Southeast Asia, and MENA. Traditional remittance fees average 6.49% (World Bank, 2026); stablecoin fees are typically under 1%. Stablecoins already account for 5–10% of flows in the U.S.–Mexico remittance corridor (Mizuho research). In countries like Argentina and Venezuela, dollar-backed stablecoins function as a digital safe haven against currency devaluation.[28][10]

Consumer-to-Business (C2B — Digitally Native Sectors)

C2B payments represent ~25% of real-economy stablecoin flows and are most prevalent in gaming, gambling, online subscriptions, and digital services with globally distributed customer bases. This is highly relevant for Web3 gaming platforms where global users require frictionless USD-equivalent payments without bank account dependencies.[^10]

Treasury and Cash Management

Corporations are using stablecoins for 24/7 treasury positioning, intraday liquidity, and inter-company funding — particularly when traditional banking rails are closed on weekends or holidays. JPMorgan's JPM Coin, Citibank's Canton Network participation, and Goldman Sachs experiments with tokenized deposits all reflect institutional scale adoption of stablecoin treasury infrastructure.[1][10]

Stablecoin Cards (Fastest-Growing Segment)

Visa's stablecoin-linked card spend reached a $3.5 billion annualized run rate in Q4 FY2025, up 460% year-over-year. By April 2026, Visa's stablecoin settlement pilot reached a $7 billion annualized run rate, growing 50% QoQ. McKinsey estimates stablecoin-linked card spending grew to $4.5 billion in 2025, up 673% from 2024. Visa supports 130+ stablecoin-linked card programs across 50+ countries.[13][29] [^21]

4. Regulatory Landscape: The Global Framework

The most significant structural shift of 2025 was the maturation of stablecoin regulation across major jurisdictions. EY's Global Approaches to Stablecoin Regulation report (July 2025) finds regulators across nine major jurisdictions are converging around three key principles: reserve quality, disclosure transparency, and consumer protection.[^30]

United States: GENIUS Act (July 18, 2025)

The Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for U.S. Stablecoins Act is the U.S.'s first comprehensive federal digital asset legislation. Key provisions include:[^3]

- **100% reserve backing** with U.S. dollars or short-term Treasuries[^31]
- **Monthly reserve disclosures** and annual independent audits[^31]
- **Criminal penalties** for false certifications; civil penalties up to $100,000/day for unlicensed issuance[^3]
- **Consumer protections**: stablecoin holders prioritized in bankruptcy[^31]
- **No yield-bearing stablecoins** permitted[^31]
- Issuers above $10 billion fall under Federal Reserve or OCC oversight; those under $10B may opt for state-level regulation[^3]

European Union: MiCA (in effect)

MiCA requires full stablecoin issuer authorization by July 1, 2026, and mandates that 60% of EMT reserves be held in EU credit institutions. MiCA's prohibition on yield payments to stablecoin holders has constrained EUR stablecoin growth — the largest EU stablecoin has a circulating supply of just €200 million.[25][1]

Asia-Pacific: First Movers

- **Hong Kong**: Stablecoins Ordinance in effect August 2025; HSBC and Anchorpoint Financial (Standard Chartered JV) received first stablecoin issuer licenses in April 2026[18][19]
- **Singapore**: MAS operates a licensing regime; Singapore's Project Guardian explored tokenized cash for cross-border FX and securities trades with DBS, HSBC, and Standard Chartered[^1]
- **Japan**: Purpose-built legal regime in place[^2]

Global Coordination

The FSB reported in 2024 that 93% of its members have plans for new or revised crypto frameworks, and 88% specifically for stablecoins. The IMF's 2025 Departmental Paper on stablecoins outlines five policy recommendations including safeguarding monetary sovereignty, maintaining capital flow management effectiveness, and adopting FSB high-level recommendations. BIS's Annual Economic Report (June 2025) cautions that stablecoins as

currently structured "fall short" of sound money standards and poses risks to monetary sovereignty without regulation.[32][33][^34]

5. What Major Institutions Are Saying

McKinsey & Company

McKinsey's flagship 2025 report — *"The Stable Door Opens: How Tokenized Cash Enables Next-Gen Payments"* — identifies 2025 as the inflection point where stablecoins challenge incumbent payment infrastructure across five dimensions: **speed** (1–5 days → near-instant), **cost** ($15–$50 → <$0.01), **transparency**, **availability** (24/7 vs. banking hours), and **financial inclusion**. McKinsey recommends financial institutions take immediate steps to acquire digital asset talent, build tokenized payment capability, educate boards, engage regulators, and establish market blueprints.[35][1]

Boston Consulting Group (BCG)

BCG published two landmark 2025–2026 reports on stablecoins:

1. **"Approaching the Tokenization Tipping Point" (April 2025, with Ripple)**: Forecasts total tokenized assets growing from $0.6T in 2025 to $18.9T by 2033 at a 53% CAGR; estimates annual collateral and liquidity management savings of up to $300 million for global banks through tokenization[36][37]
2. **"Stablecoin Payments: The Truth Behind the Numbers" (January 2026, with Allium Labs)**: The most rigorous data-driven deconstruction of stablecoin volume. BCG finds that of $62 trillion in gross stablecoin transfers, only $4.2 trillion is economically meaningful after removing bots and protocol mechanics — and only $350–$550 billion constitutes real-economy payments for goods and services. Despite the modest absolute size, this real-economy payment segment is growing at 60% annually.[^10]

BCG's "Five Killer Tests" report (May 2025) confirms product-market fit but identifies four value dimensions (automation, cross-border speed, cost, UX) as more nuanced than marketing suggests — off-ramp friction, network fees, and fragmented infrastructure still constrain full adoption.[^38]

Citi GPS (Citigroup)

Citi published two GPS reports in 2025, both describing 2025 as **"blockchain's ChatGPT moment"**:[15][6]

- **"Digital Dollars" (April 2025)**: Original forecast of $1.6T base case / $3.7T bull case for 2030 stablecoin issuance
- **"Stablecoins 2030: Web3 to Wall Street" (September 2025)**: Revised upward to **$1.9T base / $4.0T bull case**, driven by six months of faster-than-expected growth. Projects B2B payments could represent 20–25% of total stablecoin addressable market.[7][15]

BlackRock

BlackRock's **2026 Global Outlook** contained a landmark declaration: **"Stablecoins are financial infrastructure for payments, settlement, and liquidity. Not a speculative trade."** — the world's largest asset manager, with $10 trillion AUM, calling stablecoins infrastructure. Their 2026 Thematic Outlook positions blockchain as an infrastructure modernization tool for traditional asset classes, not a speculative overlay. BlackRock also filed new tokenized Treasury products in 2026, targeting the stablecoin reserve market, where its BUIDL fund ($2.9B) is already the largest tokenized money market fund.[39][40] [41][1]

Goldman Sachs

Goldman Sachs' August 2025 "Top of Mind" report — moderated by Goldman Research's Allison Nathan — projects stablecoin issuance could reach **$1.9T by 2030 (base case)**, identifying cross-border payments ($150+ trillion market), remittances ($800B+ market), and corporate treasury as the three primary disruption vectors. Goldman's stablecoin thesis hinges on the tipping point where stablecoins transition from trading chips to payment rails — and describes banks that fail to act as structurally disadvantaged.[42][11]

J.P. Morgan

J.P. Morgan Global Research's September 2025 analysis is the most conservative among major banks, projecting stablecoin market cap of **$500–$750 billion** in the coming years — roughly 2–3x from then-current levels. J.P. Morgan acknowledges that forecasts of $2 trillion by 2028 are "a little bit optimistic" but affirms that the GENIUS Act could "further accelerate stablecoin adoption, moving this asset class more mainstream". The firm also warns of significant run risks and potential financial stability spillover effects.[^12]

Deloitte

Deloitte's 2025 report — **"2025: The Year of Payment Stablecoins"** — identified the $200B+ USD-backed PSC market as no longer niche, with five core findings:[43][44]

1. PSCs are transitioning from crypto trading to mainstream B2B and B2C payment applications
2. Traditional finance (banks, fintechs, asset managers) are building PSC custody, issuance, and reserve banking infrastructure
3. Depegging, cyberattacks, and smart contract flaws represent existential risks requiring airtight governance
4. USD-backed PSC issuers can earn yield from high-quality liquid assets like U.S. Treasuries — a profitable, low-risk new revenue path
5. 2025 is the tipping point for institutional decision-making

IMF

The IMF's 2025 Departmental Paper (No. 25/09) — **"Understanding Stablecoins"** — provides the most comprehensive multilateral analysis of stablecoin architecture, risks, and policy. The IMF identifies five policy priorities: safeguarding monetary sovereignty, maintaining capital flow management effectiveness, addressing fiscal risks, adopting FSB high-level recommendations, and enforcing legal clarity. The IMF notes that stablecoins' centralized issuer structure makes them more amenable to regulation than unbacked crypto assets — but warns about risks of currency substitution in countries with weaker monetary frameworks. [^32]

BIS

The Bank for International Settlements published two major stablecoin-related outputs in 2025–2026:

1. **Annual Economic Report (June 2025)**: Proposes a "unified ledger" vision combining tokenized central bank reserves, commercial bank money, and government bonds as the next-generation monetary system. Describes stablecoins as falling short of sound money without regulation[^33]
2. **Project Agorá** (now in live testing): A 7-central-bank, 43-institution collaboration to build a tokenized cross-border payment system. The project entered prototype testing by early 2026, with Phase 1 sandbox expected to conclude in H1 2026. Live pilots include Citigroup and JPMorgan swapping tokenized USD/GBP for T+0 FX settlement (vs. current T+2)[45] [46]
3. **BIS Speech on Stablecoins (April 2026)**: Frames the central interoperability challenge — stablecoins inherit the constraints of the infrastructure on which they circulate, making public permissionless blockchain security incentive structures a critical factor for scale[^47]

Federal Reserve

The Fed's April 2026 FEDS Note — **"Stablecoins in 2025: Developments and Financial Stability Implications"** — documents 50% market cap growth during 2025 but identifies three new structural vulnerabilities: (1) increasingly complex intermediation chains between issuers and third-party service providers, (2) strategic vertical integration combining multiple business functions under single entities, and (3) accelerating retail adoption through digital wallet partnerships. The Fed warns that the opacity generated by multilayered service provision can precipitate confidence crises and trigger disruptive runs.[^5]

World Economic Forum

The WEF published a February 2026 analysis — based on Wharton Blockchain and Digital Asset Project research — noting stablecoin market cap hit ~$300 billion and annual transaction volume exceeded $34 trillion (Visa data), though stripping out high-frequency trading and bots reduces this 80%. WEF positions stablecoin evolution as dependent on

macroeconomic conditions, geopolitical dynamics, and competitive response from traditional financial firms — not technology alone.[^48]

EY

EY's July 2025 **"Global Approaches to Stablecoin Regulation"** report analyzes nine major jurisdictions and finds regulators converging around reserve quality, disclosure transparency, and consumer protection. EY's December 2025 Enterprise Blockchain Services Horizons report notes stablecoins are becoming a "common financial instrument" but that global regulatory fragmentation remains a key challenge before stablecoins can become a universal payment standard.[49][30]

PwC

PwC's 2025 Global Crypto Regulation Report documents that 88% of FSB members expect to align with the FSB stablecoin framework by 2025, and highlights U.S. bank-issued stablecoins backed by insured deposits and greater consumer protections as the expected regulatory model.[50][34]

a16z

a16z's **"State of Crypto 2025"** report documents stablecoin total volume at $46T (106% YoY), adjusted volume at $9T (87% YoY), and declares stablecoins "the backbone of the onchain economy". The report identifies the regulatory tipping point (GENIUS Act + CLARITY Act) as transforming the U.S. from "hostile to constructive" on digital assets. a16z's key analytical insight: **the scalability wars are largely won; the institutional on-ramps are open; what remains is building applications that the majority of crypto owners will actually use.**[9][4]

Fireblocks

Fireblocks' **"State of Stablecoins 2026"** report (May 2026) is the most operationally focused, surveying real enterprise deployments:[^24]

- 86% of firms report infrastructure readiness for stablecoin adoption — shift from pilots to execution[^24]
- 90% of surveyed institutions are actively taking action on stablecoins[^28]
- 41% say speed is non-negotiable; 34% say compliance is mission-critical[^23]
- Cross-border payments emerged as the top application globally; 71% of Latin American respondents use stablecoins for cross-border payments[^28]

Visa

Visa has taken the most production-oriented approach among payment networks:[^51]

- **$7 billion** annualized stablecoin settlement run rate as of April 2026, up 50% QoQ[^21]
- Expanded to **9 blockchains** (Ethereum, Solana, Avalanche, Stellar, Canton, Polygon, Tempo, and others)[^21]

- Supports **130+ stablecoin-linked card programs** in 50+ countries[^21]
- Visa's stablecoin-linked card spend grew 460% YoY to a $3.5B run rate in Q4 FY2025[^29]

6. The Infrastructure Economics: Who Makes Money

Business Model	Revenue Mechanism	Example
Stablecoin Issuance	Yield on reserves (T-bills, repos)	Tether made $54B in 2024 with ~100 staff[^38]; Circle earned $1.7B[^38]
Custody & Key Management	SaaS platform fees, transaction fees	Fireblocks, BitGo, Anchorage Digital[^16]
Payment Rails (Blockchain)	Gas fees, validator rewards	Solana, TRON, Ethereum L2s[^10]
Orchestration / Payment Processing	Transaction % or flat fee per payment	Triple-A, BVNK ($30B annualized volume)[^52]
On/Off-Ramp Infrastructure	FX spread, conversion fees	MoonPay, Transak, Wyre[^22]
Compliance & Analytics	SaaS licensing	Chainalysis, Elliptic, TRM Labs[^1]
Card Network Settlement	Network fees	Visa (9 blockchains, $7B annualized)[^21]

The most profitable segment today is reserve-bearing issuance — with near-zero marginal cost of issuance and yield generation from 100% high-quality liquid asset reserves. However, BCG and a16z both argue that **the next $100B in value will be captured at the distribution and infrastructure layer, not issuance** — solving what one analyst calls the "Last-Mile Arbitrage": the gap between institutional stablecoin liquidity and emerging market distribution networks.[^17]

7. Critical Risks and Structural Vulnerabilities

Every major institutional report identifies a consistent set of structural risks that must be addressed for stablecoins to fulfill their infrastructure potential:

Run Risk

The TerraUSD collapse (May 2022) demonstrated that algorithmic stablecoins can lose their peg catastrophically. Even reserve-backed stablecoins face run risk if reserves are not fully transparent and liquid. J.P. Morgan explicitly warns of "significant run risks" in which a large group of investors redeem simultaneously, with potential spillover to traditional banking.[^12]

Reserve and Depegging Risk

Deloitte identifies depegging, cyberattacks, and smart contract flaws as existential risks requiring "airtight governance, robust treasury and IT controls, and transparency measures". The GENIUS Act and MiCA both mandate 1:1 high-quality liquid asset reserves and regular third-party audits to address this.[43][25][^31]

Complex Intermediation and Opacity

The Federal Reserve identifies the growing complexity of intermediation chains — where multiple third-party service providers stack on top of each other — as creating cascading failure risks not present in traditional financial systems. When a wallet provider's stablecoin is built on top of an infrastructure provider's stablecoin, a depeg at any layer can cascade upward.[^5]

Regulatory Fragmentation

Despite convergence trends, significant regulatory fragmentation persists. MiCA and the GENIUS Act have different reserve requirements, yield restrictions, and supervisory structures. An issuer building for both the U.S. and EU must restructure reserve arrangements post-launch, which is significantly more expensive.[25][49]

Monetary Sovereignty

Both the IMF and BIS warn that widespread adoption of dollar-backed stablecoins in emerging markets — while beneficial to users — can undermine local monetary policy effectiveness and, if domestic currency use declines, challenge sovereign monetary control. This creates political economy risks in exactly the markets where stablecoins have strongest product-market fit.[33][32]

Concentration Risk

Two issuers — Tether and Circle — control 88% of total stablecoin supply. While this concentration enabled the regulatory clarity and institutional integration needed for mainstream adoption, it introduces systemic dependency on two private entities.[^17]

8. The Road Ahead: 2026 and Beyond

Near-Term Milestones (2026)

- **MiCA full enforcement deadline:** July 1, 2026 for stablecoin issuers in the EU[^8]
- **GENIUS Act implementation rules:** Final rules targeted July 2026[^25]
- **BIS Project Agorá Phase 1** conclusion: H1 2026; if successful, Phase 2 opens to emerging-market central banks[^46]
- **HSBC HKD Stablecoin:** H2 2026 retail and merchant launch via PayMe app[^53]
- **Anchorpoint (Standard Chartered JV):** B2B stablecoin launch targeting corporate use cases[^53]

Structural Convergence Trends

The 2026 outlook is defined by **infrastructure convergence** — the integration of tokenized bank deposits, CBDCs, and regulated fiat-backed stablecoins through shared global rails: [^54]

1. **TradFi to DeFi Convergence**: Banks that master stablecoin infrastructure gain operational advantages in cross-border payments, 24/7 treasury management, and programmable settlement that traditional rails cannot support[^17]
2. **Stablecoin → Settlement Standard**: Ethereum remains the center of gravity for institutional RWA settlement, hosting $12.5B in tokenized assets (~65% market share); but Visa's multi-chain approach signals settlement will be multi-rail[^20]
3. **Card Networks as Stablecoin Infrastructure**: Visa and Mastercard are actively building stablecoin settlement into their network architecture — not just via partnerships but at the scheme level[^51]
4. **Bank Issuance at Scale**: U.S. banks are in active discussions to jointly issue a stablecoin; the GENIUS Act permits bank subsidiary issuance under primary federal regulator oversight[3][1]
5. **Value Migration**: From issuance (commoditized by Circle and Tether) to **distribution infrastructure** — the firms that solve last-mile connectivity from institutional stablecoin liquidity to end users in emerging markets will capture the next generation of value[^17]

BCG and industry leaders across multiple reports converge on a single message: **institutions that delay risk competing from a position of permanent cost disadvantage by 2027.**[^17]

Report synthesized from McKinsey (2025), BCG (2025, 2026), Citi GPS (2025 ×2), BlackRock (2026), Goldman Sachs (2025), J.P. Morgan (2025), Deloitte (2025), IMF Departmental Paper 25/09, BIS Annual Economic Report (2025) and Project Agorá, Federal Reserve FEDS Note (2026), World Economic Forum (2025, 2026), EY (2025), PwC (2025), a16z State of Crypto 2025, Fireblocks State of Stablecoins 2026, Visa press releases (2026), BCG/Ripple Tokenization Tipping Point (2025), and Stablecoin Insider 2025 Year-End Report.

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